

Password Requirements

1. Password Requirements

All employees are responsible for protecting their company accounts and passwords.

Password Rules

Employees must:

- Use a password of at least **12 characters**.
- Include a combination of **uppercase letters, lowercase letters, numbers, and special characters**.
- Use a unique password for company accounts.
- Avoid using names, birthdays, phone numbers, or other easily guessed information.
- Never share passwords with colleagues or other individuals.
- Avoid writing passwords on paper or storing them in unsecured files.
- Use the company's approved password manager when one is provided.

Password Changes

Employees should change their password immediately if they believe that their account has been compromised.

Employees must not reuse an old company password when creating a new password.

Example

A strong password should be difficult to guess and should not contain easily identifiable personal information.

Company Laptop Usage

2. Company Laptop Usage

Company laptops are provided for authorized business activities and must be handled responsibly.

General Rules

Employees must:

- Use company laptops primarily for authorized work activities.

- Keep the laptop physically secure when working in the office or remotely.
- Lock the screen whenever leaving the laptop unattended.
- Install software only when it is approved by the company's IT department.
- Keep the operating system and security software updated.
- Use the company's approved network or VPN when required.
- Avoid connecting unknown USB drives or external devices to the company laptop.

Data Protection

Employees must not:

- Copy confidential company information to personal devices.
- Store sensitive company documents on unauthorized cloud storage.
- Share company files with unauthorized individuals.
- Disable antivirus or other security software installed by the IT department.

Employees should immediately inform the IT department if a company laptop is lost, stolen, or damaged.

Phishing Awareness

3. Phishing Awareness

Phishing is a cyberattack in which an attacker attempts to trick employees into providing sensitive information or opening malicious content.

Common Warning Signs

Employees should be cautious when an email or message:

- Requests passwords or confidential information.
- Contains unexpected attachments.
- Includes suspicious links.
- Creates a sense of urgency or threatens immediate consequences.
- Comes from an unfamiliar sender.
- Contains unusual spelling, grammar, or formatting.
- Requests financial information or unusual payments.

Safe Practices

Employees should:

1. Verify the sender before responding.
2. Avoid clicking suspicious links.
3. Avoid opening unexpected attachments.
4. Check website addresses carefully before entering credentials.
5. Contact the sender through a trusted communication method if a request appears unusual.
6. Report suspected phishing messages to the IT/security team.

Important

Employees should never provide their company password in response to an unexpected email or message.

Reporting Security Incidents

4. Reporting Security Incidents

Employees must report suspected security incidents as soon as possible so that the IT/security team can investigate and respond.

Examples of Security Incidents

Employees should report:

- Lost or stolen company laptops.
- Suspected phishing emails.
- Unauthorized access to company accounts.
- Accidental sharing of confidential information.
- Malware or suspicious software activity.
- Unusual account activity.
- Lost company devices or storage media.
- Any suspected data breach.

Reporting Process

Employees should follow these steps:

1. Stop interacting with the suspicious file, email, link, or application.
2. Do not delete evidence unless instructed by the IT/security team.
3. Contact the company's **IT Security Team** immediately.
4. Provide relevant details such as the time of the incident and what happened.
5. Follow instructions provided by the IT/security team.
6. Change affected passwords if instructed.

Emergency Contact

IT Security Team: it-security@abctech.example

IT Helpdesk: helpdesk@abctech.example

Employees should report incidents promptly even if they are unsure whether the situation is a genuine security incident.